

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS

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"I go forward - though my sinew be shrunk".

Challenging our disabilities

Genesis 32:32 Therefore the children of Israel eat not of the sinew which shrank, which is upon the hollow of the thigh, unto this day: *because he touched the hollow of Jacob's thigh in the sinew that shrank.* KJV
Genesis 32:32 Therefore the sons of Israel do not eat the *sinew which shrank*, which [is] on the hollow of the thigh, unto this day, because He came against the hollow of Jacob's thigh, against *the sinew which shrank.* YLT

Genesis 32:24-32

24 So Jacob was left alone, and a man wrestled with him till daybreak.

25 When the man saw that he could not overpower him, *he touched the socket of Jacob's hip so that his hip was wrenched* as he wrestled with the man.

26 Then the man said, "Let me go, for it is daybreak." But Jacob replied, "I will not let you go unless you bless me."

27 The man asked him, "What is your name?" "Jacob," he answered.

28 Then the man said, "Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel, because you have struggled with God and with men and have overcome."

29 Jacob said, "Please tell me your name." But he replied, "Why do you ask my name?" Then he blessed him there.

30 So Jacob called the place Peniel saying, "It is because I saw God face to face, and yet my life was spared."

31 The sun rose above him as he passed Peniel, and he was limping because of his hip.

32 Therefore to this day the Israelites do not eat the tendon attached to the socket of the hip, because the socket of Jacob's hip was touched near the tendon. NIV

31 and the sun riseth on him when he hath passed over Penuel, and he is halting on his thigh;

32 therefore the sons of Israel do not eat the sinew which shrank, which [is] on the hollow of the thigh, unto this day, because He came against the hollow of Jacob's thigh, against the sinew which shrank.

YOUNGS LITERAL TRANSLATION

Genesis 32:24-32 NIV

Close encounter with God

24 So Jacob was left alone, and a man wrestled with him *till daybreak.*

■ THAT HE (the man) COULD NOT OVERPOWER HIM, (Jacob)

25 When the man saw that he could not overpower him, *he touched the socket of Jacob's hip so that his hip was wrenched* as he wrestled with the man.

■ HE TOUCHED THE SOCKET OF JACOB'S HIP SO THAT HIS HIP WAS WRENCHED - *AS HE WRESTLED WITH THE MAN.* - Verse 25

■ HIS HIP WAS WRENCHED - - Verse 25

■ THE ANGEL REQUESTS / COMMANDS -

26 Then the man said, "Let me go, for it is daybreak."

JACOB REPLIES "*I will not let you go unless you bless me*" - Verse 26

■ *IMAGINE MAN REFUSING TO OBEY AN ANGEL OF THE LORD* and NOT LETTING GO *UNTIL HE HAD RECEIVED* WHAT HE DESIRED FROM THE ANGEL (GOD) WHICH WAS TO BE BLESSED

■ *What BOLDNESS, TENACITY and PURSUIT of purpose!* Verse 26

27 The man asked him, "What is your name?" "Jacob," he answered.

28 Then the man said, "Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel, because you have struggled with God and with men and have overcome."

29 Jacob said, "Please tell me your name." But he replied, "Why do you ask my name?" Then he blessed him there.

30 So Jacob called the place Peniel, saying, "*It is because I saw God face to face, and yet my life was spared.*"

31 The sun rose above him as he passed Peniel, *and he was limping because of his hip.*

32 Therefore to this day the Israelites do not eat the tendon attached to the socket of the hip, because the socket of Jacob's hip was touched near the tendon.

- JACOB LEFT PENIEL LIMPING
31 The sun rose above him as he passed Peniel, *and he was limping because of his hip.*
32 Therefore to this day the Israelites do not eat the tendon attached to the socket of the hip, because the socket of Jacob's hip was touched near the tendon.
- BECAUSE THE SINEW SHRUNK
Genesis 32:32 Therefore the children of Israel eat not of the sinew which shrank, which is upon the hollow of the thigh, unto this day: *because he touched the hollow of Jacob's thigh in the sinew that shrank.* KJV
Genesis 32:32 Therefore to this day the children of Israel do not eat *the muscle that shrank*, which is on the hip socket, because He touched the socket of Jacob's hip *in the muscle that shrank.* NKJV.
- BUT IN SPITE OF THE ANGEL SHRINKING HIS SINEW AND DISABLING HIM JACOB prevailed with the angel and would not let go of the angel until he blessed him
- So Jacob CONTINUED TO press FORWARD – reaching out for that he wanted from the angel – and that was to be blessed.
- Jacob was SEVERELY DISABLED and experiencing pain and discomfort but HE PRESSED THROUGH even prevailing with the angel UNTIL he received his blessing
- SO, REGARDLESS OF HIS DISABILITY JACOB CONTINUED TO GO FORWARD

THE LESSON FOR US IS:

- FOR US TO CONTINUE TO GO FORWARD REGARDLESS OF WHAT DISABILITIES WE MAY HAVE.
- WHAT MIGHT BE YOUR DISABILITY?"
- What is it that restricts you from going forward?
- * Is it your lack of EDUCATION OR maybe that you cannot SPEAK well?
- * Is it your TIMIDITY and SHYNESS or your LOW SELF-ESTEEM?
- * WHAT DISABILITY OR HANDICAP do you have which you think prevents you from reaching your desired goal?
- * Is it something IN THE PAST that HAS EMOTIONALLY DAMAGED or DISADVANTAGED you?
- * Is it some PAST FAILURE that had crippled you emotionally.
- * What is the disability that dominates (controls) your thinking and preventing you from GOING AHEAD,
- * Maybe you think that you don't have sufficient STRENGTH to press on to do other things?
- * Maybe you CANNOT RUN any more as you once did BUT at least you can walk – SO WALK AND GO FORWARD.

What is the DISABILITY that prevents you FROM PRESSING ON?

- * Is it PEOPLE or FAMILY PRESSURES that intimidate you from believing and progressing towards those desire that you have for serving God.
- * It is family RESPONSIBILITIES that you MUST fulfill and if so, fulfill those obligations joyfully but don't lose your desire in asking God how you can serve him while in those circumstances
- * Is it your AGE which does not allow you do things like you once could, but there are still some things that you can do for God so be actively asking him for guidance and they will come to you.
- DO WHAT YOU CAN WITH WHAT YOU HAVE and God will enable you
- * IS YOUR DISABILITY past FAILURE or HURT or exposed to OFFENCE, if so God wants you leaving those things behind AND STILL GO FORWARD towards those things that he has destined for you.
- JACOB WENT FORWARD EVEN WITH HIS DISABILITY/ HANDICAP.
- YOU ALSO CAN GO FORWARD with whatever your handicap might be.
- * WE SHOULD NOT ALLOW OUR DISABILITIES TO PREVENT US FROM BEING A BLESSING TO THE LIVES OF OTHERS.
- * BE COURAGEOUS AND NOT ALLOW YOUR IMPERFECTIONS OR DISABILITIES TO PREVENT YOU FROM POSSESSING ALL THAT IS RIGHTFULLY YOURS – through Christ's death and resurrection.
- * BE DETERMINED TO GO FORWARD EVEN THOUGH IT MAY SEEM TO BE IMPERFECT AND NOT AS WOULD HAVE DESIRED.
- * CHOOSE TO BELIEVE in the things God promised to BE and to DO for his people. That his promises are absolutely true. That they can be completely relied upon.
That he never lies. That he has never failed to keep his promise. His promises are his word and express WHO HE IS.
- * CHOOSE TO REMAIN POSITIVE AND NEGATIVELY in the way you think.
- * CHOOSE NOT TO FOLLOW another person's pathway if it means abandoning the way of faith and trusting God.
- * CHOOSE to be DISCIPLINED in your mind and heart and you will be POSITIONING and READYING yourself for whatever FUTURE PATHWAY you are to take.
- * CHOOSE TO GO FORWARD REGARDLESS OF WHAT YOUR PERSONAL CIRCUMSTANCES MIGHT BE.

LET US MAKE THIS YOUR MOTTO!

"I will go forward even though my sinew be shrunk".